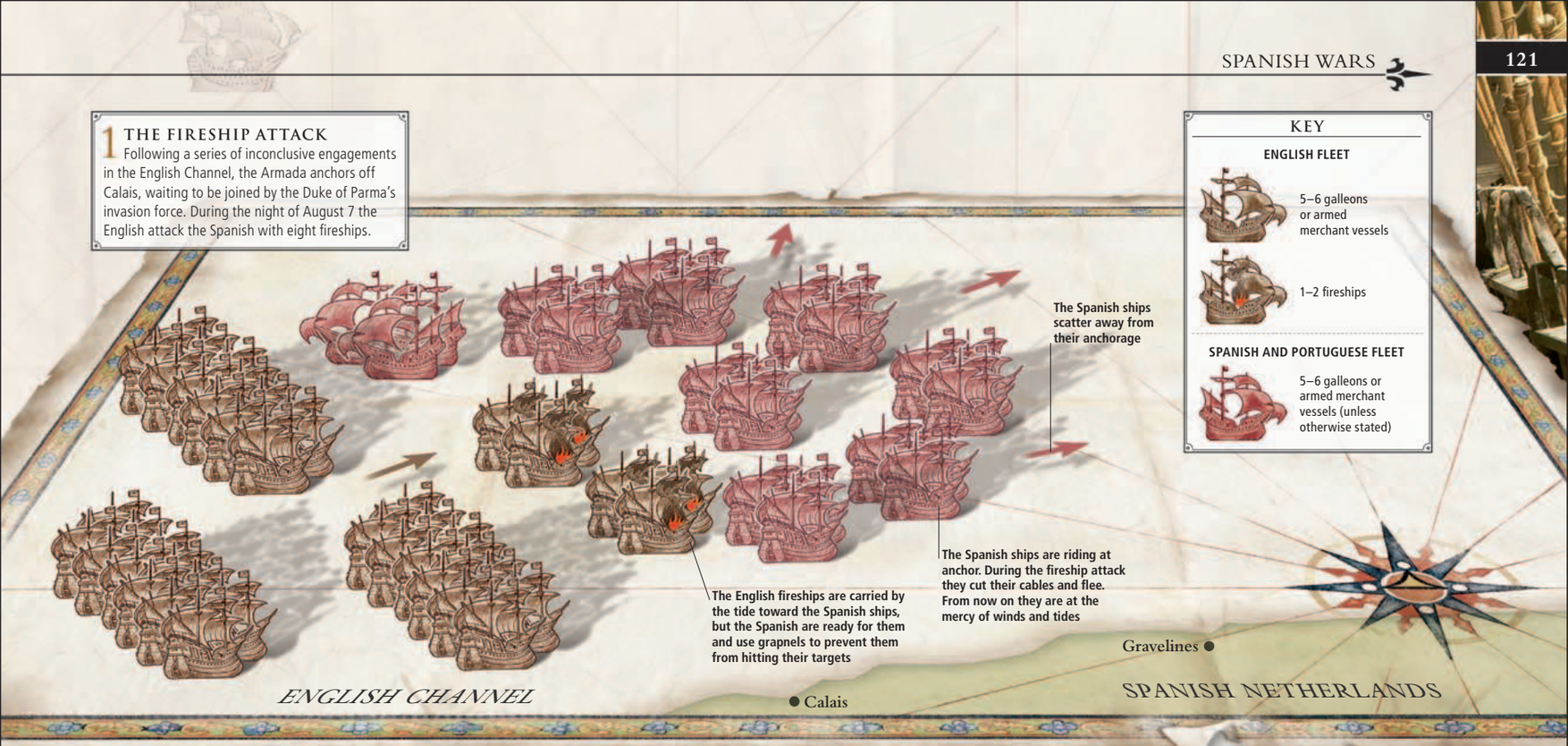
1 THE FIRESHIP ATTACK

Following a series of inconclusive engagements in the English Channel, the Armada anchors off Calais, waiting to be joined by the Duke of Parma's invasion force. During the night of August 7 the English attack the Spanish with eight fireships.



2 THE POSITION AT DAWN

The English close in to exploit the confusion caused by the fireship attack. A few galleons under the command of Medina Sidonia manage to hold off the attacks of Sir Francis Drake's squadron, while the other Spanish ships struggle to regroup.



3 THE BATTLE OF GRAVELINES

Many Spanish ships are damaged, a few run aground, but only one ship is sunk. After nine hours' fighting, bad weather forces the English, who are low on ammunition, to break off the action. The wind changes and forces the Spanish northward.

